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Digital Tools

Technology For Personal And SoHo Productivity

Enhance

IN PLACE

Getting mails in order and cutting that Inbox down to size will have a positive impact on your life... take it from us!

Asfaq Tapia

“**I**nbox” has a meaning: it’s a place where mails have come into, waiting to be read and processed, then either discarded or kept in an appropriate place. The Inbox was never meant to be a heap of hundreds or even thousands of mails.

It’s not an idle matter of perfection. Consider this. If your Inbox is too large, you could spend too much time finding a mail you’re looking for – if you know it exists. Second, if there are too many mails there, there are probably some important ones whose existence you’ve forgotten about – and no appropriate action has been taken. Third, if you’re struggling to “catch up on your e-mailing,” you’d tend to begin at the beginning – of that huge Inbox, and two things could happen: (a) Looking at that heap, you might never start; and (b) If you do, your attention would be divided as you juggle between personal and official mails, less important ones and more important ones.

There’s more: if you only use the standard mail folders in Outlook (we’re assuming, keeping numbers in mind, that Outlook is your mail client), and you have too many mails, the file could get corrupt (meaning you could lose all of them).

To get to the point, it is this: that it’s desirable to have a trim Inbox, well-organised folders, and a ready backup for when things go wrong. While talking about all this, we can’t avoid the subject of spam, either. And so, while there are many philosophies one can subscribe to on one’s journey to becoming a good e-mailer, we’ll keep what follows to the essentials.

A Few Obvious Things

Almost all of e-mail wisdom can be put in three concise lines:

- ☒ Keep unwanted stuff from getting in.
- ☒ What gets in, classify into what needs action and what doesn’t.

